Flavours & Fragrances of the Reader

Unit 1 –**The Portrait of a Lady** is a biographical sketch describing the bond between a grandson and his grandmother, filling the mind with reminiscences of the past. Children identify their personal relationship with their own grandparents and learn humane qualities of kindness, respecting the old and showing concern to their relations. The poem **Once upon a Time**, speaks of falsity concealed behind smiles, absence of genuine appreciation concealed by a facade of hypocrisy and the longing of an adult for the innocence of childhood. The Supplementary lesson **After Twenty Years** by O.Henry delineates the duty-consciousness of a true policeman, who is torn between love for his friend and his professional loyalty.

Unit 2- **The Queen of Boxing** is an excerpt from the autobiography of Mary Kom M.C., a highly talented and courageous Boxing Champion who had overcome many challenges in her life. Her life story is a source of inspiration and encouragement. The poem, **Confessions of a Born Spectator** by Ogden Nash speaks of the spectator's attitude to sports/ sportsmen and the need to develop confidence to face and overcome challenges. The Supplementary lesson **A Shot in the Dark** by Saki is an interesting story which points out that sometimes truth is misinterpreted and people who think they are acting wisely are not always right. The feelings and actions of fellow human beings have to be trusted and given due respect.

Unit 3- **Forgetting**, an essay by Robert Lynd, teaches us to overcome the deficiencies and to concentrate better with greater focus on our actions. **Lines Written in Early Spring** is a poem by William Wordsworth, stressing the fact that Nature is meant for Man's joy and pleasure, but this very source of joy is destroyed by Man himself. It is a reminder to Man to preserve Nature in all her beauty. The play **The First Patient** is a funny interlude bringing out the psychological fear everyone experiences on visiting a dentist to extract a tooth. The play portrays high humour in the reaction of the patients when tools are being carried in to force open a jammed cupboard.

Unit 4- **Tight Corners** by E.V. Lucas, portrays the need for wisdom to tackle things when in a crisis and learn that rash and hasty acts will only result in folly, adding misery and woe to one indulging in thoughtless action. The poem **Macavity, the Mystery Cat** by T. S. Eliot, is a highly amusing poem, listing out the devilish mischiefs of a cat. The Supplementary story **With the Photographer** by Stephen Leacock, humorously yet sharply speaks of the reality wherein the narrator's original features are distorted under the pretext of making them more appealing by an over-enthusiastic photographer, leaving the narrator pained and disgusted, as there is no resemblance between himself and the photograph.

Unit 5- **The Convocation Address** by Aringnar Anna is an enlightening speech offering valuable advice and guidance to youngsters, instilling a sense of duty and service in them, urging them to give back to society what they have gained from it. The poem **Everest is not the only Peak** highlights one's need for aspiration towards excellence in whatever activity one indulges in. It is a poem of optimism and offers encouragement to learners, emphasizing that they have to excel in their work and carry it out with perseverance and courage. The Supplementary story **The Singing Lesson** by Katherine Mansfield, traces the delicate and tender feelings of a young music mistress who is dejected at the rejection of her partner and is later filled with joy when a telegram from the partner indicates a re-union.

Unit 6 – **The Accidental Tourist** is an amusing account by Bill Bryson, who always messes up things bringing about great embarrassment to himself and his family whenever he tours and travels by flight. The poem **The Hollow Crown**, which is an excerpt from Richard II by William Shakespeare, speaks of the vanity of life and how Death is the ultimate conqueror, rendering everything powerless and meek when one succumbs to defeat. The second play **The Never, Never Nest** reflects the greed of youngsters to own more and more luxurious articles on loans, paying huge instalments and spending their entire lifetime repaying the loans incurred.

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